

Week 3 — Pulse Diagnosis

EAM310 · East Asian Medicine Diagnosis I · VUIM Summer 2026

⚠ Quiz 2 — July 24, 2026

Class: Friday July 25, 2026 · 9AM-1PM

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REQUIRED READINGS — due before July 25

FCM CHAPTER 25 — MACIOCIA

- The Normal Pulse (平脈 Ping Mài)
- Three essential qualities: 胃神根
- 28 pulse qualities — full descriptions
- Clinical groupings by pattern
- Pulse qualities at individual positions

CAM CHAPTER 13 — CHENG XINNONG

- Normal pulse description
- 28 pathological pulse types
- Yin/Yang classification of pulses
- Pulse-taking method review
- Pulse qualities in disease

WEEK 3 LEARNING OBJECTIVES (CLO 1, 4, 5, 6)

- Describe the characteristics of a normal pulse
- Name the three essential qualities (胃神根) and explain each
- Identify the 28 classical pulse qualities by feel and name
- Classify pulses by Yin/Yang grouping (CAM framework)
- Explain what each pulse quality indicates clinically
- Differentiate easily confused pulse pairs (e.g., Wiry vs Tight)
- Apply pulse findings to the six positions bilaterally
- Integrate pulse with tongue for pattern differentiation

ASSESSMENT CALENDAR

Date	Event	Material Covered
Jul 24 — TOMORROW	⚠ Quiz 2	Week 2: Four Pillars, 8 Principles, Tongue intro, Pulse intro
Jul 25 — THIS FRIDAY	Week 3 Class	Normal Pulse, 28 Pulse Qualities, in-class palpation practice
Jul 31	Quiz 3	Week 3 material — Pulse Diagnosis
Aug 7	MIDTERM + Journal 1-25	Weeks 1-4 comprehensive
Sep 11	FINAL + Journal 26-50	Weeks 6-9 comprehensive

IN-CLASS PRACTICE — What to expect Friday

PALPATION LAB

Week 3 includes hands-on in-class practice on pulse palpation. Come ready to:

- Practice three-finger placement on a partner (Cun/Guan/Chi bilaterally)
- Identify depth levels — superficial, middle, deep
- Attempt to name at least 3-5 qualities you feel in a live practice pulse
- Document your findings in your Pulse/Tongue Journal (entry counts toward midterm)

EAM Diagnosis Notes — Week 3

Pulse Diagnosis Cheat Sheet · 脈診 Mài Zhěn

FCM Ch.25 · CAM Ch.13

July 25, 2026

PULSE POSITIONS — 寸關尺 · Both Hands

Hand	Cun 寸 (distal)	Guan 關 (middle)	Chi 尺 (proximal)
Left Heart side	Heart / SM Intestine chest, Pericardium	Liver / Gallbladder	Kidney Yin / Bladder Lower Jiao (L)
Right Lung side	Lung / LG Intestine chest	Spleen / Stomach	Kidney Yang / Bladder Lower Jiao (R)

NORMAL PULSE 平脈 · Three Essentials 胃神根

Quality	Normal Finding	Essential	Meaning
Rate	4–5 beats/resp · 72–80 bpm	胃 Wèi	Stomach Qi: flowing, harmonious
Depth	Middle level — not too sup/deep	神 Shén	Spirit: strong, rhythmical
Strength	Forceful but not excessive	根 Gēn	Root: deep at Chi — Kidney Qi
Rhythm	Regular — no skipped beats		

28 PULSE QUALITIES — Quick Reference

↑ FLOATING GROUP		RATE GROUP		WIDTH / SHAPE GROUP	
浮 Fú Floating	Exterior / Yin def	數 Shuò Rapid	>5/resp — Heat	弦 Xián Wiry	Liver · pain · violin string
芤 Kōu Hollow	Blood/fluid loss	遲 Chí Slow	<4/resp — Cold	滑 Huá Slippery	Phlegm · pearls rolling
革 Gé Leather	Jing/Blood loss	疾 Jí Racing	>7/resp — extreme Heat	澀 Sè Choppy	Blood stasis · scraping
↓ SINKING GROUP		STRENGTH GROUP		洪 Hóng Flooding	Excess Heat · wave
沉 Chén Deep	Interior	實 Shí Full	Excess — forceful all levels	細 Xì Thin	Blood def · thread
牢 Láo Firm	Cold accumulation	虛 Xū Empty	Def — weak all levels	濡 Rú Soggy	Damp · float+thin+soft
伏 Fú Hidden	Severe Interior Cold	弱 Ruò Weak	Deep + fine + soft	長 Cháng Long	Excess · past positions
RHYTHM GROUP		微 Wēi Frail	Barely perceptible	短 Duǎn Short	Qi def/stag · one position
結 Jié Knotted	Slow + irreg. skips			緊 Jǐn Tight	Cold · twisted rope
促 Cù Hurried	Rapid + irreg. skips			大 Dà Overflowing	Full Heat · wide
代 Dài Reg. Intermit.	Slow + fixed gaps △				

△ KEY DISTINCTIONS TO KNOW COLD

Wiry vs Tight: Wiry = taut violin string · Tight = twisted vibrating rope (colder, more pain) | **Slippery vs Flooding:** Slippery = smooth rolling (normal width) · Flooding = large wave (big force) | 代 **Dài** = **worst rhythm:** regular fixed-interval skips = organ Qi declining

